

Activity 1. Analyzing vague language in complex sentences.

Instructions:

- Read each pair of sentences carefully.
- Identify which sentence expresses greater certainty.
- Explain how grammar and vocabulary contribute to that effect.
- Rewrite the less certain sentence to make it stronger without changing the core meaning.

Example:

Pair 1

A. The new policy will significantly reduce traffic congestion in urban areas within the next year.

B. The new policy is expected to contribute to a noticeable reduction in traffic congestion in many urban areas over time.

Sentence B is less certain.

- “is expected to” indirect prediction
- “contribute to” partial impact (not direct cause)
- “a noticeable reduction” vague language.
- “many urban areas” It is not specific
- “over time” undefined period.

Example of rewriting the sentence to make it stronger:

The new policy is going to reduce traffic congestion in urban areas within the next year.

Pair 2

A. The restaurant appears to have struggled, possibly due to certain management issues and a decrease in customer interest.

B. The restaurant failed because of poor management decisions and declining customer satisfaction.

Pair 3

A. Climate change is directly responsible for the increase in extreme weather events worldwide.

B. Climate change may be one of several factors contributing to what seems to be an increase in extreme weather events in various parts of the world.

Activity 2. Classifying vague language characteristics.

Instructions: Classify the following expressions into the correct category.

around 50	and stuff like that	several	that thing
approximately	some	or something	a number of
more or less	a few		

List completers	Quantifiers	Placeholders

- 1. Which expressions are common in spoken English?
- 2. Which ones would sound informal in professional writing?
- 3. Which ones indicate approximation?

Activity 3. From specific to general. Strategic variation.

Instructions: Rewrite the following base sentences in a highly precise version and a vague language version.

Example 1:

Base sentence: The company improved its profits after launching the new product.

Highly precise version: The company increased its profits by 12% within six months of launching the new product.

Vague language version: The company experienced some improvement in its profits after launching the new product, although results varied in different markets.

Example 2:

Base sentence: The city experienced population growth last year.

Highly precise version: The city's population increased by approximately 8,500 residents in 2024.

Vague language version: The city saw a noticeable rise in population last year, with several new residents moving into different neighborhoods.

Base sentence 1: Online shopping has changed consumer behavior.

Highly precise version:

Vague language version:

Base sentence 2: The movie was successful after its release.

Highly precise version:

Vague language version:

Base sentence 3: The new phone model attracted customers.

Highly precise version:

Vague language version:

Base sentence 4: Remote work affects employee productivity.

Highly precise version:

Vague language version:

Activity 4. Guided writing and speaking practice.

Discussion Topics:

1. TV shows have a negative influence on society.
2. Technology is making people less patient.
3. Celebrities should not share their political opinions publicly.

Example:

It could be argued that reality TV has some negative effects, particularly in terms of unrealistic expectations. However, in some cases, these shows may also provide entertainment and opportunities for unknown individuals to gain visibility...

Useful language:

- It could be argued that...
- There seems to be...
- A number of people believe that...
- In some cases...
- More or less...

In teams, select a topic to write and discuss about. Each member should write at least one paragraph of your text. Be prepared for questions.